

Most living rooms are lit for cleaning, not for living: one bright fixture in the ceiling, flattening everything it touches. A winter room wants the opposite — light brought down to the height of a seated person and broken into three soft pools at different heights. A paper pendant for the high note, a table lamp at the elbow, a low warm sconce for the corner that would otherwise go black. Put them on 2700-kelvin bulbs, the warmest you can buy, and the evening stops being something to switch on against.

Then the cloth. Winter comfort is not one expensive throw; it is two cheaper weights of the same colour layered — a flat-woven wool over a chunkier knit, a linen cushion in front of a bouclé one. The eye reads the layering as warmth before the hand confirms it.

Last, the edit. A winter surface should carry one stone object, one living thing — a branch counts — and nothing else. The temptation in the dark months is to fill the room against the emptiness. Resist it. The empty half of the table is doing the same work as the lamp.

